

Nutrition Starter Guide

Your map for Module 2 · Nutrition for Optimal Fertility · Fuel your body like it's preparing for a miracle

The one rule

Every meal gets a protein, a fat, a fiber, and a color. Protein and fat steady blood sugar (quieter cravings), fiber feeds the gut bacteria that regulate estrogen and immunity, and color brings the antioxidants that protect the egg and the sperm. Nothing is counted. Four questions, every plate.

The fertility plate

SECTION	SHARE OF PLATE	EXAMPLES
Vegetables + a little fruit	½	leafy greens, broccoli, peppers, carrots, berries, tomatoes, cabbage
Protein	¼	eggs, oily fish, poultry, beans, lentils, tofu/tempeh, full-fat plain yogurt or kefir
Slow carbohydrate	¼	oats, quinoa, brown rice, sweet potato, whole-grain bread, beans (double duty)
Healthy fat (drizzle)	—	extra-virgin olive oil, avocado, nuts, seeds, oily fish

Adapted from Harvard's Healthy Eating Plate. Works with any cuisine: dal + rice + vegetable curry; beans + rice + salsa; miso soup + rice + fish + pickles.

Top fertility foods and why

FOOD	KEY NUTRIENTS	EVIDENCE IN ONE LINE
Leafy greens	folate, magnesium, fiber	Folate 400 mcg/day from ≥1 month pre-conception (ACOG, CDC); higher folate intake linked to higher live-birth rates in ART (Gaskins et al., <i>Obstetrics & Gynecology</i>)
Berries	polyphenols, fiber	Antioxidant-rich diets associated with better semen quality (Salas-Huetos et al., <i>Human Reproduction Update</i>)
Avocado, olive oil	monounsaturated fat	Trans fats linked to ovulatory infertility; MUFA the opposite (Chavarro et al., <i>AJCN</i>)

FOOD	KEY NUTRIENTS	EVIDENCE IN ONE LINE
Oily fish (low mercury)	omega-3, vitamin D, protein	Couples eating more seafood conceived sooner (Gaskins et al., <i>JCEM</i> , 2018)
Walnuts, nuts & seeds	omega-3 ALA, zinc, fiber	75 g walnuts/day improved sperm vitality, motility and morphology in 12 weeks (Robbins et al., <i>Biology of Reproduction</i>)
Beans & lentils	plant protein, fiber	Replacing some animal protein with plant protein linked to lower ovulatory infertility risk (Chavarro et al., <i>AJOG</i>)
Eggs	choline, protein, vitamin D	Choline supports early brain development (ACOG)
Full-fat plain dairy (if tolerated)	protein, fat, live cultures	Full-fat dairy linked to lower anovulatory infertility risk vs low-fat (Chavarro et al., <i>Human Reproduction</i>)
Fermented foods	live cultures	10 weeks of fermented foods increased microbiome diversity and lowered 19 inflammatory markers (Wastyk et al., <i>Cell</i> , 2021)

Ease off: trans fats, ultra-processed snacks and processed meats, sugar-sweetened drinks ($\approx 20\%$ lower monthly fecundability, Hatch et al., *Epidemiology*), high-mercury fish (swordfish, king mackerel, tilefish, bigeye tuna), alcohol (minimal or none while trying; ASRM/ACOG).

Module 2 at a glance

TRAINING	RUNTIME	RESOURCE	ACTIONS (XP)	TOTAL
T1 · Fertility-Boosting Foods	11	Grocery List.xlsx	Plan 1 meal 40 · Prepare & eat 30 · Share photo 20	90
T2 · Managing Sugar Cravings	9	Sugar Swap Recipes.pdf	Try 1 swap 40 · Track mood/energy 30 · Share 20	90
T3 · Hydration & Detox Drinks	8	Drink Recipes.pdf	Log water 30 · Make 1 drink 40	70
T4 · Gut Health Essentials	12	Gut Health Quiz.pdf	Add 1 probiotic food 40 · Journal 30 · Share tips 20	90
T5 · Meal Planning Templates	10	Meal Template.xlsx	Plan 3 meals 50 · Prep & follow 30	80
T6 · Food Sensitivities & Elimination	11	Elimination Guide.pdf	Quiz 40 · Remove 1 food 30 · Report 20	90
T7 · Supplements for Fertility	9	Supplement Checklist.pdf	Research 1 30 · Start with doctor approval 40	70

TRAINING	RUNTIME	RESOURCE	ACTIONS (XP)	TOTAL
T8 · 7-Day Nutrition Challenge	12	Challenge Tracker.pdf	Daily tasks 50 · Reflect 30 · Share wins 20	100
Module completion bonus				10

Ground rules for this module

- This is not a diet. Nobody counts calories or earns food. We add before we subtract.
- If you have a history of restriction or out-of-control eating, do the elimination training (T6) with a professional or skip it and focus on adding.
- Supplements, elimination diets and herbal teas go through your doctor, midwife or a registered dietitian first.
- Get tested for celiac disease **before** removing gluten (the blood test only works while you're eating it).
- Grace over guilt: a craving you ate is information, not failure.

Your "why" for this module

"For my future family, I want my plate to give them _____."

Educational content only, not medical advice. Always consult your doctor or a qualified health professional before changing supplements, diet, exercise or detox practices, especially while trying to conceive.